

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 27, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 47:1–12

1 Then he brought me back to the door of the temple; and there was water, flowing from under the threshold of the temple toward the east, for the front of the temple faced east; the water was flowing from under the right side of the temple, south of the altar.

2 He brought me out by way of the north gate, and led me around on the outside to the outer gateway that faces east; and there was water, running out on the right side.

3 And when the man went out to the east with the line in his hand, he measured one thousand cubits, and he brought me through the waters; the water came up to my ankles.

4 Again he measured one thousand and brought me through the waters; the water came up to my knees. Again he measured one thousand and brought me through; the water came up to my waist.

5 Again he measured one thousand, and it was a river that I could not cross; for the water was too deep, water in which one must swim, a river that could not be crossed.

6 He said to me, "Son of man, have you seen this?" Then he brought me and returned me to the bank of the river.

7 When I returned, there, along the bank of the river, were very many trees on one side and the other.

8 Then he said to me: "This water flows toward the eastern region, goes down into the valley, and enters the sea. When it reaches the sea, its waters are healed.

9 And it shall be that every living thing that moves, wherever the rivers go, will live. There will be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters go there; for they will be healed, and everything will live wherever the river goes.

10 It shall be that fishermen will stand by it from En Gedi to En Eglaim; they will be places for spreading their nets. Their fish will be of the same kinds as the fish of the Great Sea,

exceedingly many.

11 But its swamps and marshes will not be healed; they will be given over to salt.

12 Along the bank of the river, on this side and that, will grow all kinds of trees used for food; their leaves will not wither, and their fruit will not fail. They will bear fruit every month, because their water flows from the sanctuary. Their fruit will be for food, and their leaves for medicine.

II. Key Summary

- Ezekiel is brought back to the door of the temple and sees water flowing out from under the threshold toward the east, running from the right side of the temple, south of the altar.
 - With a measuring line in his hand, the man measures one thousand cubits at a time and brings Ezekiel through the water each time: first ankle-deep, then knee-deep, then waist-deep; after the fourth measurement it has become a river too deep to cross, one that must be swum.
 - The water flows east into the sea and the waters there are healed; everything lives wherever the river goes, fish become exceedingly many, trees grow on both banks bearing fruit every month, and their leaves are for medicine.
-

III. Passage Analysis

The river comes out of God's house

Significantly, the river does not come from a king's palace or a government building. It doesn't come from a marketplace, a place of business, or an athletic arena. It comes from God's house. [1]

Everything abundant that Ezekiel sees — the fish, the trees, the fruit, the healing — is not something the land produces on its own; it arrives with the water. The passage spells it out in its last verse: "because their water flows from the sanctuary."

Wherever the water reaches, life comes back

Wherever the water flowing from the temple goes, living things teem with life. Once it reaches the Dead Sea in particular, that place becomes a fishing ground full of fish. This means that no matter how useless a person may be, once they receive the word of truth they become someone useful to God and to others. [2]

The Salt Sea was the one body of water everyone knew could keep nothing alive, yet the passage says that the moment this water enters it, the sea is healed and the fish multiply. What settles the outcome is not how dead that water was to begin with, but whether this river reaches it.

IV. Reflection Question

When something hurts, who is the first person you go to so you can feel better?

In this passage even the sea was healed, and the water that healed it flowed from only one place — God's house.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Ezekiel 47 – The River of Life,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-47/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Sacred Bible Study Commentary (聖經精讀本),
Ezekiel Chapter 47, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT47.htm>